

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1030

By Bricken

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Tullahoma High School students on winning three national awards at the FBLA National Leadership Conference.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to those students who, through their natural talents and unflagging commitment to academic excellence, have distinguished themselves in the classroom and beyond; and

WHEREAS, three students from Tullahoma High School recently won national awards at the Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA) National Leadership Conference in Anaheim, California, an extraordinarily rare accomplishment for any school, as winning even one national award is a remarkable achievement; and

WHEREAS, FBLA is a nonprofit educational organization whose first chapter was established in Johnson City in 1942; the organization has since grown to encompass more than 250,000 members and advisors nationwide; and

WHEREAS, FBLA inspires and prepares students to become community-minded business leaders in a global society through relevant career preparation and leadership experiences; and

WHEREAS, Tullahoma's Edward Henry and Jonah Vallejos were recognized as national winners in the LifeSmarts Challenge, while their teammate, Thomas Cunningham, earned the title of national winner in the Electronic Career Portfolio event; and

WHEREAS, these young men's achievements reflect months of rigorous preparation, academic commitment, and leadership development; and

WHEREAS, these students first competed at the State Leadership Conference, at which they placed first in Tennessee by besting fields of twenty or more participants; advancing to the

national level, they competed against as many as 200 students in preliminary rounds before ultimately placing in the top ten in their events and being recognized as national winners; and

WHEREAS, Edward Henry and Jonah Vallejos finished in a five-way tie for fourth place, while Thomas Cunningham placed ninth, less than 0.75 points from first place, margins that reflect the extremely competitive nature of the events; and

WHEREAS, Thomas Cunningham earned Tullahoma High School's FBLA's first two perfect scores at the national level; he had previously earned a perfect score at the state level in middle school; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his success in national competition, Edward Henry currently serves as a Tennessee State FBLA officer and has aspirations to seek national office; and

WHEREAS, Thomas Cunningham has completed all levels of the FBLA Business Achievement Awards, including his Capstone Project, which will receive recognition at the 2026 FBLA National Leadership Conference; and

WHEREAS, the Tullahoma High School FBLA national winners' display of talent and dedication surely bodes well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, their achievements are a tremendous source of pride for their families and their school and have brought positive attention to their community from across the nation; and

WHEREAS, these young men have represented Tullahoma, Coffee County, and the State of Tennessee with distinction, and they are clearly deserving of our respect, admiration, and commendation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Edward Henry and Jonah Vallejos of Tullahoma High School on winning a national award in the LifeSmarts Challenge and Thomas

Cunningham on winning a national award in Electronic Career Portfolio at the FBLA National Leadership Conference, extending to them our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.